



1. The Global Context Extract B (lines 4-5) refers to global investment undertaken by China.

Explain the term 'global investment' **and** analyse **two** economic consequences for an economy receiving such investment.

[9 marks]

2. 'The UK economy has recently been in the grip of its worst recession for 60 years.'

Explain possible reasons for an economy moving from a period of prosperity to one of recession.

[15 marks]

3. The Global Context Extract B (lines 5–8) argues: "It now seems unlikely that economic 'powerhouses' such as India and China will provide support for the global economy through trade and investment. Such support might have helped avoid world recession and restored economic growth."

Explain the term 'world recession' **and** analyse how **both** trade **and** investment can help to bring about economic growth.

[9 marks]

4. The European Union Context Extract D (lines 13–14) argues that it 'is not difficult to understand why the pound has fallen against the euro and other currencies'.

Explain what is meant by 'the pound has fallen against the euro and other currencies' **and** analyse **two** determinants of such a fall.

[9 marks]

5. The Global Context Extract B (lines 35–37) concludes: 'Globalisation must surely have played its part in the success of the UK economy...whatever problems it may also have created.'

Using the data and your economic knowledge, to what extent do you agree with the view that globalisation has been of benefit to UK macroeconomic performance?

[25 marks]

6. An economy which is enjoying rapid economic growth experiences a significant rise in the external value of its currency within a floating exchange rate system.

Explain the factors which may lead to a rise in the exchange rate of a currency within a floating exchange rate system.

[15 marks]

7. 'Failure to get a new trade deal would put another dark cloud over the world economy.'

Source: PETER MANDELSON, EU Trade Commissioner, July 2008

Explain the main economic determinants of a country's demand for imports.

[15 marks]



8.

'Failure to get a new trade deal would put another dark cloud over the world economy.'

Source: PETER MANDELSON, EU Trade Commissioner, July 2008

Evaluate the significance for the UK balance of payments on current account of increased use of protectionist policies around the world.

[25 marks]

9.

'Inflation needs to be avoided at all costs but it is nowhere near as damaging to an economy as deflation.'

To what extent might it be argued that inflation is preferable to deflation?

[25 marks]

10.

The European Union Context Extract Extract D (lines 27–28) states that 'the impact of the increased government borrowing arising from budget deficits across the EU is of concern amongst some economists'.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the impact on the UK economy of increased government borrowing by EU governments.

[25 marks]

THE EUROPEAN UNION CONTEXT

Extract D: Is EU unity threatened?

Europe, and indeed much of the world, was shaken by the depth of the economic downturn from 2008. Many countries, including the UK, saw the solution to be a return to Keynesian economics and, therefore, tolerance of large budget deficits. This was coupled with significant monetary expansion, so that, in the UK for example, the Bank of England Bank Rate was cut to 0.5% in 2009, accompanied by a policy of 'quantitative easing' (increases in the money supply). 1
5

The UK pressed other EU governments to embark on fiscal expansion. Not all shared the UK's enthusiasm and, at best, wanted only a much more modest fiscal stimulus than was the case in the UK. However, events sometimes overtook such wishes. Ironically, given the scale of the UK fiscal stimulus, until the latter part of 2009 the UK was the only major economy to remain in recession. This may reflect the greater significance of the housing and financial sectors in the UK compared to other EU countries. 10

The fiscal position of many EU countries has given rise to concern. Italy, for example, now has a national debt (the total outstanding debt of central government) of around 120% of GDP, even though its annual budget deficit is not exceptionally large. Some countries have shown a greater determination than Italy to cut their deficits. In December 2009, for example, Ireland announced sharp cuts in public sector wages. But it is certainly not just Italy which has shown complacency. The EU's Stability and Growth Pact limits annual borrowing to 3% of GDP. EU governments are under increasing pressure to return to this target by 2014. 15
20

The short- to medium-term benefits of fiscal expansion during downturns cannot be denied. Government spending can initiate a powerful stimulus to an economy through the multiplier process. Aggregate demand therefore rises. The UK Pre-Budget Report put government spending at £676 billion. Tax cuts will give households more spending power. Coupled with cheap credit and retail price discounts, recovery can therefore be helped through increased consumption. 25

However, the impact of increased government borrowing arising from budget deficits across the EU is of concern amongst some economists. It may eventually force the authorities to increase interest rates, lead to 'crowding-out' of private sector activity and make public spending cuts and tax increases an inevitability. In the UK, for example, a VAT rate of 17.5% was restored in January 2010 following a temporary cut to 15%. Equally, the 2009 Pre-Budget Report announced an increase in National Insurance contributions. 30

The problem in trying to assess the impact of fiscal expansion is, of course, not knowing what might have happened without it. Certainly, some economists are quick to attribute the end of recession in France and Germany in 2009 to such fiscal loosening. Indeed, it is difficult to argue that, for any country in the EU, economic growth and employment cannot be beneficial to some extent at a time when business and consumer confidence are both at a low level. 35

Whether such a policy eventually causes inflation to make an unwelcome return remains to be seen. At that point, EU members may experience a greater urgency to balance budgets and reduce monetary expansion. 40

Source: various sources, 2010



12.

The Global Context Extract B (lines 33–34) argues that ‘the living standards of developed countries, including the UK, will be affected by economic growth in Africa’.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the view that living standards in the UK are likely to benefit from sustained economic growth in the economies of Africa.

[25 marks]



THE GLOBAL CONTEXT

Extract B: Living standards

Economists can generally agree on the causes of economic growth such as investment, innovation and improvements in productivity. There is greater disagreement over the consequences. An important part of the debate is the impact of economic growth on living standards. The debate has become more complex as measurement of living standards has taken on greater sophistication. GDP per capita (income per head) remains one of the basic measures.

Supporters of continued economic growth point to increased consumption possibilities, greater welfare, more support for the disadvantaged and more resources for health, education and infrastructure.

Opponents of unlimited economic growth point to the rapid depletion of exhaustible natural resources and environmental deterioration. The Copenhagen Summit of December 2009 brought the latter issue into sharp focus once again.

Various indices, such as the Human Development Index, incorporate a number of factors into their calculations in order to give as comprehensive a view of living standards as possible and to allow more accurate international comparisons. Factors include life expectancy, infant mortality and nutritional levels.

The Legatum Institute publishes a global survey annually, popularly known as a 'prosperity index'. It brings together data on, for example, economic growth, welfare, happiness, crime and healthcare. This data is then used to rank countries.

The 2009 index ranked 104 countries. The UK was placed 12th (its best position for three years). Low scores for key public services kept it out of the top ten. All African countries were in the bottom half of the index.

However, the continent of Africa is undergoing economic change. The World Bank points to a rapid transformation in some countries. Mozambique has seen annual average growth of 8% in the last decade, Kenya has emerged as a major global supplier of cut flowers and Rwanda is developing tourism very successfully. While Lesotho is developing its clothing industry, Ethiopia is starting to manufacture footwear. Can we look to Africa for the next wave of 'emerging economies', to follow India and China? In 2009, Africa as a whole had the world's third highest rate of growth behind India and China. Africa's role as a major supplier of raw materials to China also illustrates its increasing economic links with the rest of the world.

As a result of this economic change, living standards in Africa will no doubt improve. Additionally, the living standards of developed countries, including the UK, will be affected by economic growth in Africa. Export markets for both goods and services will strengthen, as will investment opportunities, and natural resources will become more accessible.

But how long before the UK faces stiff competition from Africa in agriculture, manufacturing and service activities? No one can accurately predict the impact on the UK economy but the careful monitoring of developments in Africa will become increasingly necessary.

Source: various sources, 2010



14. The deficit on the UK balance of trade in goods and services rose from £26 billion in 2003 to £44 billion in 2008.

Evaluate government policies which might bring about a reduction in the UK deficit on the balance of trade in goods and services.

[25 marks]

15. The deficit on the UK balance of trade in goods and services rose from £26 billion in 2003 to £44 billion in 2008.

Explain the main factors which might help determine the volume of UK exports and imports.

[15 marks]

16. 'While it is necessary to have macroeconomic policy objectives, such as price stability and full employment, they can sometimes prove difficult to reconcile.'

Explain the various macroeconomic policy objectives **and** their importance to an economy.

[15 marks]

17. **The European Union Context Extract D** (lines 35-36) argues that 'a more ambitious set of common macroeconomic policies would help speed recovery in the EU'.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the impact on the UK economy of a recovery in the EU as a whole.

[25 marks]

18. 'Oil, as a form of energy, reigns supreme but it has brought significant problems to economies in terms of inflation in particular, and the potential for economic instability in general.'

Discuss how rising oil prices might affect the macroeconomic performance of an economy.

[25 marks]

THE EUROPEAN UNION CONTEXT

Extract D: Is European Union (EU) unity threatened?

In March 2009, the Hungarian Government asked Germany for €190 billion to prevent what it saw as a new economic 'Iron Curtain' from going up across Europe. The term 'Iron Curtain' was intended to remind Europeans of the Soviet-era divide between the poorer Communist East and the more prosperous, free, democratic West. Hungary argued that, without such help, the contrast between the richer and poorer members of the EU would only widen further. Germany's refusal of Hungary's request symbolised, for many, the deepening divide between the EU's richer and poorer members.

The contrast in fortunes is seen by newer members of the EU, such as Latvia, Lithuania and Hungary, as one which can only worsen during the recession and which may threaten the EU's existence in the long term. On the other hand, some people in the more-established members of the EU, such as the UK and France, have become increasingly disillusioned with the EU and especially with the level of assistance now expected from these more-established members by the newer members.

At the Brussels Summit of March 2009, the Czech Prime Minister warned of 'the greatest crisis in the history of European integration'. Gordon Brown, for the UK, spoke of the need for unity and common policies. The Single European Market, for example, is seen as an evolving policy which can foster prosperity for all and bring closer integration.

Cyclical unemployment is now widespread, however, and has been growing faster in the Eastern members of the EU than in those of the West. This could increase tensions between Eastern and Western members of the EU. The impact of cyclical unemployment on both individuals and whole economies can be serious, as incomes and output fall and welfare-dependency becomes more widespread.

Nevertheless, it would be wrong to argue that the wealthier members of the EU have been totally immune to the problem. The Netherlands, the worst affected Western member, experienced a 34% rise in unemployment between January 2008 and March 2009. There was a much greater rise in Latvia and Lithuania, both in the East.

During a recession, questions are likely to be asked about the future of the EU as policy disagreements emerge. Supporters claim that the EU is a force for good and needs to be strengthened, rather than weakened or abandoned. In this way, it is argued, East-West tensions can be kept at bay.

Such supporters feel that an enlarged EU, with open markets based on the Single European Market policy, helps spread benefits of membership across the whole organisation and offers the best chance of rapid recovery. In the UK, however, many see openness as a threat to jobs and to living standards.

In the current climate, it has also been argued that a more ambitious set of common macroeconomic policies would help speed recovery in the EU. Fiscal and supply-side policies come into this category, as well as monetary policy, even though only 16 members of the 27-member EU have adopted the euro. Even so, limited agreement on monetary policy, such as interest rates, could be of benefit.

The UK has not had the leading role in EU recovery policies that it has had globally, but it has shown a willingness to play its part in fostering unity and economic revival so that Europe can make a vital contribution to international recovery. Talk of disunity and the break-up of the EU can only cause instability and hinder economic recovery. This is something that members can ill-afford, particularly the UK. Growth, jobs and stable prices are desperately needed.

Source: various sources



20.

In 2009, the World Bank described the Chinese economy as a “relative bright spot in an otherwise gloomy global economy” (**The Global Context Extract B**, lines 34-35).

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the consequences for the UK economy of China’s continued economic growth during a global recession.

[25 marks]

21.

‘The long-term progress made towards a free-trade world must be maintained. Calls for greater protectionism would lead to a disastrous collapse of global economic activity.’

Explain **three** protectionist policies that a government could introduce to reduce a deficit on the current account of the balance of payments.

[15 marks]



THE GLOBAL CONTEXT

Extract B: China: a bright spot in a gloomy world

China, despite its recent rapid growth, has not remained immune to the economic downturn as some economists had hoped. However, it remains an economy which is looking to the future with some optimism. It continues to invest in the production of raw materials and resources in other countries. The consequent increased global investment should give a much-needed boost to jobs and growth in countries benefiting from it. Despite this investment, growth in demand from China is likely to continue to push up world raw material prices in the long term.

Certainly, China has shown an increased recognition of the need to play its part in bringing about global recovery. For example, in a recent international agreement to boost the funds of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) by \$500 billion, China has agreed to contribute \$40 billion, compared to the UK's \$15 billion. The IMF can now fulfil its promise of loans to such countries as Poland and Mexico, which should contribute to the greater global stability needed for recovery.

Nevertheless, China, fearing inflation, has expressed its concern about the policy of some leading central banks, including the Bank of England, of quantitative easing (increasing the money supply) in order to bring about economic revival by increasing aggregate demand. China also knows that its policy of holding down the external value of its currency in order to boost export-led growth is only likely to be successful if a global revival of demand is achieved. For example, China saw a 25% decline in exports in 2008. The depressed UK market will have contributed to this decline.

The other major world economies are keen to keep talking with China and win its approval for a host of measures to bring about recovery. They want to engage China in more long-term talks as well. These will include international financial reforms and environmental policies, especially as China's industrial growth continues to create negative externalities.

China has every reason to be optimistic about its future prospects. In June 2009, the *Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development* (OECD) forecast growth for that year of 7.7% and 9.3% for 2010. To a country used to double-digit growth figures, this may seem like a recession. However, such figures are a far cry from the negative growth seen in many parts of the global economy, including the UK economy.

Nevertheless, the ongoing concern of the Chinese Government is reflected in the decision to give a \$565 billion fiscal stimulus to its economy in 2009. It is also considering protectionist policies, which may impact on those countries hoping to increase exports to China. For the World Bank, however, the Chinese economy remains a 'relative bright spot in an otherwise gloomy global economy' and countries such as the UK are keen to see China help pull the global economy out of recession.

China has reacted coolly to suggestions that a solution to the world's economic problems lies in the hands of two powers: itself and the US. Although the UK has played a leading role in international discussions on recovery, such an assertion may yet prove to have a ring of truth. What is certain is that co-operation is vital in ensuring that appropriate policies are followed to bring about a new era of sustained growth.

Source: various sources, 2009

23.

'The long-term progress made towards a free-trade world must be maintained. Calls for greater protectionism would lead to a disastrous collapse of global economic activity.'

Assess the view that the progress made towards free trade has brought significant economic benefits **both** to the UK **and** to the rest of the world.

[25 marks]



24.

The Global Context Extract B (lines 29 –30) states that ‘the UK needs to have a strong economy to be able to respond successfully to all types of global event ...’.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the significance to UK macroeconomic performance of major global events such as sports competitions, natural disasters and economic downturns.

[25 marks]

25.

The European Union Context Extract D (lines 33 –34) argues that the ‘UK must not be blind to the potential problems of Turkey’s possible membership of the EU and must also be in a position to grasp the opportunities which are sure to appear’.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the potential economic consequences for the UK if Turkey joined the EU.

[25 marks]



26.

THE EUROPEAN UNION CONTEXT

Extract D: Turkey – gateway to Asia

Turkey has been in talks since 2005 regarding possible membership of the European Union (EU). While further enlargement of the EU causes some concern, serious consideration needs to be given to Turkey. Its geographical position links Europe and Asia. Since Asia is currently driving world economic growth, Turkey can be an important strategic gateway to Asia for the EU. 1
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The UK Government supports Turkey's application for EU membership but questions still persist. If Turkey joins the EU, can the UK successfully take up the resulting trade and investment opportunities? Will the UK be overwhelmed by imports and cheap migrant labour? Will UK businesses be determined enough to grasp any opportunities?

Turkey has a population of 75 million, which is expected to rise to 100 million by 2020. The average age is just 27 and it has vast economic potential. Turkey's GDP is ranked 18th in the world, and GDP per capita is £7163. Like the UK, there has been some negative growth in recent years but the economy recovered to achieve 11% growth in the first quarter of 2010. Between 2002 and 2007, Turkey's annual average economic growth of 7% was far greater than that of the UK. 10
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About 50% of Turkey's exports are to Europe, with textiles being particularly important. Machinery and semi-manufactured goods are major imports. The UK does not yet rank alongside countries such as Germany, Italy, China and the US as important exporters to Turkey, but opportunities certainly exist.

Turkey has had a reputation for economic instability. Since 2005, for example, inflation has been between 5% and 12%. Unemployment has remained in double figures: 10% of the labour force in 2005 and 14% currently. However, Turkey now boasts a relatively modest budget deficit of between 4% and 5% of GDP. 20

Despite a degree of instability, Turkey is seen as an attractive centre for investment. For example, the country received £115 bn in foreign direct investment in 2009. However, Turkey's infrastructure still leaves much to be desired. 25

UK businesses need to consider the potential economic opportunities. Lord Digby Jones, formerly of the *Confederation of British Industry* (CBI), points out that Turkey's recent economic growth is from a low base. According to Lord Jones, "Whereas a little bit of growth in a prosperous country such as Germany does not make much difference, in a developing country such as Turkey millions of people get richer". This is perhaps an exaggeration, especially in the short run, but a valid point is being made. 30

The UK must not be blind to the potential problems of Turkey's possible membership of the EU and must also be in a position to grasp the opportunities which are sure to appear.

Source: news reports, 2010

27.

The Global Context Extract B (lines 13 –15) refers to the possible benefit to the UK and other economies if countries hosting major sports competitions become more open to investment in the long term.

Explain the term 'investment' **and** analyse **two** possible economic benefits for the UK when it is investing overseas.

[9 marks]

THE EUROPEAN UNION CONTEXT

Extract D: The fiscal remedy for recession

The recession of 2009 brought renewed interest amongst EU governments in a so-called Keynesian approach to spending their way out of recession. They were desperate to avoid a prolonged period of negative growth and the accompanying mass unemployment. 1

In the UK, as well as within the eurozone, fiscal rules were abandoned as the fight for economic recovery began. The Stability and Growth Pact of the eurozone, to which the UK had also adhered in an informal way before the recession, limited budget deficits to 3% of GDP and a nation's debt to 60% of GDP. Such constraints were often far exceeded and increasing concerns were being expressed. In May 2010, the new UK Government became a prominent voice within Europe for a reversal of fiscal policy, with public spending cuts and tax increases. 5
10

The UK Government's policy was given some support by the economic crisis unfolding in Greece, a member of the eurozone. The Greek Government needed to be 'bailed out' by fellow member states if it was not to default on its debts. It had a budget deficit of 14% of GDP and a national debt of 115% of GDP in 2009, a year when its GDP also fell by 2%.

There was concern in the EU that such a situation had been allowed to develop, with increasing calls for EU-wide controls. France and Germany were pressing for an EU institution such as the European Commission to provide such a role, with the power to impose an EU-wide fiscal policy on all member states and not just the eurozone. 15

The UK Government opposed any such powers over member countries. However, it had gone as far as to establish an Office for Budget Responsibility (OBR), intended to keep the Government's tax and spending plans under control by providing a reality check on the state of the nation's finances. The OBR, however, does not have the powers that some were envisaging for the EU. 20

In a climate of greater stability in 2010, some still believed that an EU-wide fiscal policy needed to be a key part of the evolution towards a federal state. It cannot be denied that the best way forward must be that which delivers macroeconomic stability across the EU. Whether this comes about through member governments each developing a policy of fiscal responsibility or through a fiscal policy imposed by the EU on all member states remains open to debate. 25

Source: various sources, 2010

Extract B: Winners and losers

The debate over the consequences of globalisation for individual countries continues. Inevitably, there will be benefits and costs, winners and losers. For example, whilst the UK has experienced deindustrialisation, its service sector has been successful in world markets.	1
As the debate continues, one aspect of globalisation cannot be disputed: that the greater integration of economies has meant that major events occurring in one part of the world will have an impact not just on the affected country or region but are now much more likely to have global significance.	5
Some events are known about well in advance of them actually happening. Major sports competitions are an example. In 2012, for instance, the UK will host the Olympic Games. Similarly, Russia and Qatar will host the football World Cup in 2018 and 2022 respectively. The economic impact of such events on host countries is likely to be positive. For other countries, the immediate impact is likely to be more limited. However, the UK and other economies could benefit if these events make the host countries more open to trade and investment in the long term.	10
Other events are far less predictable or are completely unpredictable. For example, how might the UK cope with a disruption to gas and oil supplies if relations with Russia deteriorate or political turbulence in the Middle East escalates? What path to recovery will the UK take following the devastating effects of the 2008 US financial crisis?	15
Generalisations about the economic impact of natural disasters are often unhelpful. Hurricane Katrina in 2006, which caused billions of dollars of damage in the New Orleans area of the USA, had minimal economic impact on the rest of the world. However, the Japanese earthquake and tsunami in 2011 are on a different scale. Japan accounts for 7% of world GDP. There are fears that the scale of the damage may lead to a return to recession in Japan, as fearful Japanese consumers spend less and save more. Global supply chains originating in Japan, such as car components supplied to the rest of the world, have been severely disrupted. The UK, as well as Japan's other trading partners, will struggle to maintain exports to the Japanese market until stability is restored.	20
Like any other country, the UK needs to have a strong economy to be able to respond successfully to all types of global event and to secure sustained economic growth. Important factors include high productivity, resource mobility, innovation, skilled labour, a strong infrastructure in its widest sense and general flexibility in the economy. The ability to make use of these supply-side qualities will, however, also depend on aggregate demand. The impact of major global events on UK aggregate demand will inevitably vary considerably, positively or negatively, with unknown consequences for macroeconomic performance.	25
	30
	35

Source: news reports, 2010/11

UK exports of goods which, in 2002, were valued at £187 billion, had risen to £228 billion in 2009.

The deficit on the UK balance of trade in goods rose from £48 billion in 2002 to £82 billion in 2009.

Evaluate the view that an increasing deficit in UK trade in goods is a major problem for the UK economy.

[25 marks]



31.

The European Union Context Extract D (lines 16–18) suggests that France and Germany would like the EU to have ‘the power to impose an EU-wide fiscal policy on all member states and not just the eurozone’.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the possible economic consequences for the UK economy of an EU-wide fiscal policy requiring all member states to balance their budgets.

[25 marks]

32.

UK exports of goods which, in 2002, were valued at £187 billion, had risen to £228 billion in 2009.

The deficit on the UK balance of trade in goods rose from £48 billion in 2002 to £82 billion in 2009.

Explain **three** possible reasons for growth in the value of an economy’s exports of goods.

[15 marks]

33.

The formation of single markets by countries in various parts of the world, including within Europe, has shown that much is to be gained from increased economic cooperation.

Evaluate the possible economic costs and benefits to an EU member state, such as the UK, of being part of the EU single market.

[25 marks]

34.

The Global Context Extract B (lines 2–3) states that ‘India’s economic success could help to bring some relief to the UK economy and speed the recovery process through increased exports’.

Using the data and your economic knowledge, assess the importance to the UK economy of continued economic growth in India.

[25 marks]

Extract B: A passage to India

In July 2010, the UK Prime Minister led a Government delegation to India. The hope was that India's economic success could help to bring some relief to the UK economy and speed the recovery process through increased exports. 1

India's growth in 2010 is expected to be about 9%. Its GDP per capita is \$3100, although over 400 million Indians live below the international poverty line of \$1.25 per day. It has a labour force of almost 500 million but an official rate of unemployment of 11%. Quarterly sector growth is impressive: 1.8% in services, 2.2% in manufacturing and 1.7% in agriculture between January and March 2010. 5

For the Indian Government, inflation and economic growth are top of the agenda. Unfortunately, there is often a trade-off between these two macroeconomic indicators. Inflation jumped from 1.3% in October 2009 to almost 5% in November 2009. However, food inflation was 19%. As in other countries, rising oil costs are also amongst the causes of inflation for the Indian economy. 10

The UK Government still hopes to promote increased UK economic involvement in India. Certainly Indian business has become more involved in the UK. *Tata*, one of India's oldest companies, is now the UK's leading manufacturer through its ownership of *Corus Steel and Jaguar Land Rover*. India is now more likely to be creating jobs in the UK through direct investment rather than 'stealing' them, for example through call-centre activity relocated from the UK. UK business needs to rise to the challenges and opportunities presented in India. Companies such as *Vodafone* (telecommunications) and *BAE Systems* (defence and aerospace) are amongst the recent success stories and it is widely believed that India's increased demand for world-class services, for example financial and legal, can be met by the UK. 15 20

Infrastructure investment is urgent. Each year, about 40% of India's agricultural produce rots before arriving at market because of inadequate storage facilities and poor road and rail links. The Indian Government's plans to spend \$500bn between 2010 and 2013 on new ports, roads, rail links and airports will help to improve the situation. This investment is an export opportunity for UK firms specialising in infrastructure projects. The growth of the Indian economy will also help UK service exporters such as banking, education and health-care businesses. Currently, India accounts for only 1% of UK exports. 25 30

However, India remains fiercely protective, and investment and trade flows from the UK could remain limited. Progress will depend on whether a long-awaited EU-India trade deal becomes a reality and on the outcome of the *World Trade Organization's* global trade talks. Many argue that India can only benefit from increased international trade.

The UK Government said at the time of the Prime Minister's July 2010 visit to India that the UK had a vital stake in India's rise to becoming a global power and in its future prosperity. At the same time, a view was also expressed that the UK needs India much more than India needs the UK. It is hoped that all aspects of the UK's macroeconomy can eventually benefit as India develops further. 35

Source: news reports, 2010